

“I wish the industry would not follow this ever increasing hype cycle for new stuff”

While new technologies can lead to innovations, hype often goes with the territory. **Gerald Venzl**, *senior director, product management* at **Oracle Corporation** speaks with **Abbinaya Kuzhanthaivel** about the risks of following the hype, and shares his thoughts on how to grow a career by contributing to open source projects.

Gerald Venzl, senior director,
product management, Oracle Corporation



Q. Can you tell us a bit about your journey with open source?

A. I currently work as a database product manager looking after the Oracle Database. As part of my job, I help steer the direction of the product and help pinpoint priorities in the market that need to be addressed. Often people are surprised when I tell them that open source is an important aspect of that. For example, Oracle recently launched a Kubernetes operator for its database, which is fully open source and is available on GitHub. But we have also Docker build files on GitHub, and even some of our Oracle Database drivers are

fully open source, such as our Node.js driver and the Python driver.

Q. Is Oracle your first venture into open source?

A. I was accustomed to open source in my personal life before joining Oracle. For me, open source is a natural part of my job.

Oracle has a long-standing commitment to open source with Oracle Linux, Java, MySQL and many other projects. Although the Oracle Database core is proprietary, we see the value of open source and having people to contribute and understand the technologies around it.

Q. What do you think about open source as an opportunity?

A. The thing that I like about open source is that it's essentially a democracy and everybody gets to participate. Not that all participants are core contributors, but it connects people from all over the world. The exposure to projects and other developers is important for growing your skillset and your career.

In Oracle, we are currently focusing a lot on the Kubernetes operator. That's an exciting project. In my free time, I also write little tools and open source them. I had